URBAN DESIGN IN VÄSTRA HAMNEN

HOW DO THE INHABITANTS INTERACT WITH THE URBAN DESIGN IN PUBLIC SPACES?

INTRODUCTION

"Public spaces are the living rooms, gardens and corridors of urban areas. They serve to extend small living spaces and providing areas for social interaction and economic activities, which improves the development and desirability of a community."

Västra hamnen is a coastal area in Malmö with a relatively new style in their built environment and urban design. Västra hamnen attracts different kinds of people in Sweden and tourists, for different reasons. The purpose of this poster is to investigate how people in different ages interact with urban design, as well as the green areas and built environment.

RESULTS

During these observations, I noticed that time and weather makes a difference in how and what people are using the urban design in public places. On day-time under the sun, people - the elderly as well as the young - are more willing to use most of the equipment at the public space.

A pattern I noticed during daytime and later in the afternoon, was that close to the playground most of the kids were using more than just the equipment, exploring the area. Adults in general were using the public places in a similar way, sitting down and enjoying the weather or watching the kids. On a sunny day, people were acting more freely in the urban places, compared to a cloudy day where less people were willing to use more of the public places and design.

METHODS

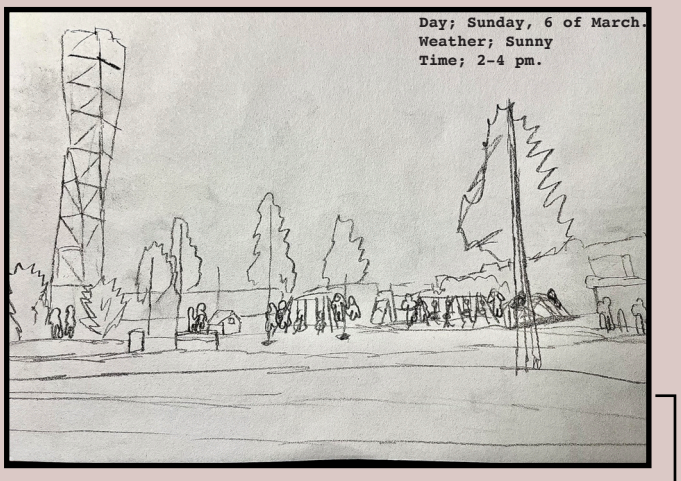
Observing people in public places, such as green areas, playground, and pathways a long the ocean.

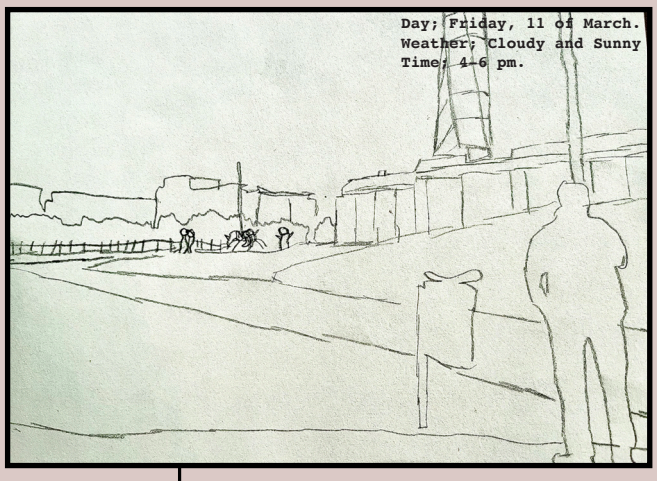
- 5 green areas, 1 playground, and 1 pathway.
- 7 times during the forenoon and afternoon.
- Taking notes
- Recording people's behavior by sketching.
- GIS-Map of Västra Hamnen with the locations.

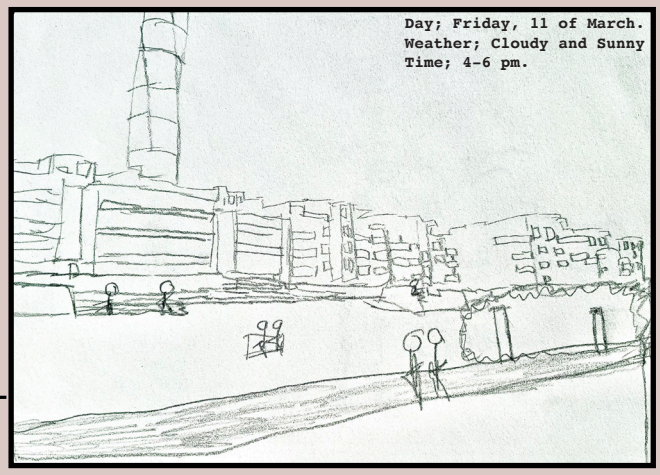
CONCLUSION

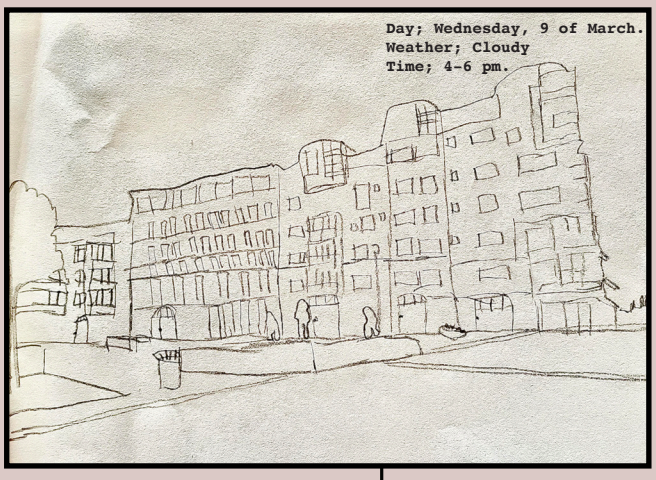
Design in urban places makes more or less no difference when it comes to kids as they are using the playground, sundeck, green areas, or other elements connected to the built environment. Adults are more reserved and follow "the pattern" at a public place. The weather has an impact on how, where, and what adults are using public spaces. Kids are more willing to interact with the urban design, no matter time or weather.

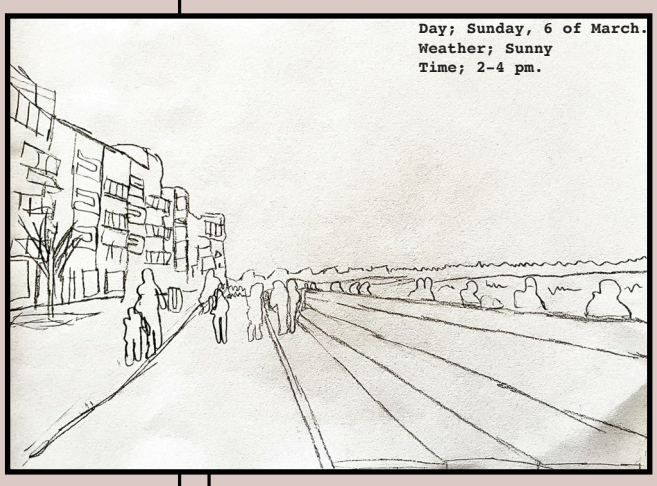
SKECTHES OF PEOPLE IN PUBLIC SPACES:

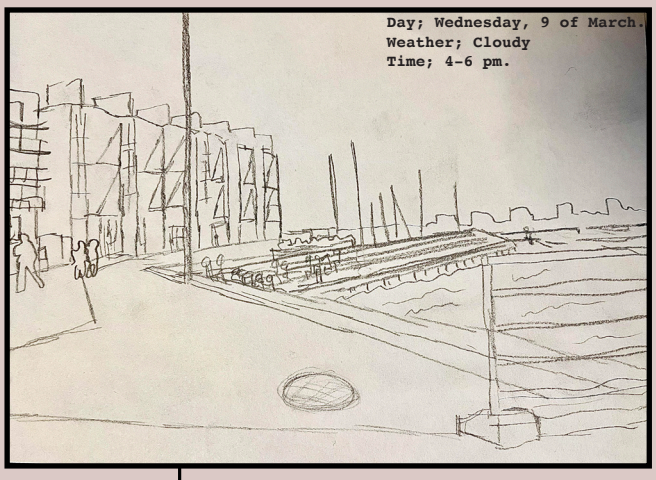














REFRENCES

Georges Perec, Species of spaces and other pieces
Barbara B. Kawulich, Colletcing data through observation
Annette M. Kim, Critical cartography 2.0: From "participatory mapping" to authoredvisualizations of power and people

MALMÖ UNIVERSITET

EMMA LEHTINEN,CATCHING URBANITY.